

Image 2.1: Maharaja Hari Singh, the last Dogra ruler (1925–49)
Source: Still extracted from Films Division footage, licensed by AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.

After Hari Singh's accession to the throne, an organisation called Anjuman-e-Nusrat-ul-Islam, founded in 1905 by the Maulvi of Srinagar's Jamia Masjid, started a movement calling for the educational emancipation of Kashmiri Muslims. As a result, many Kashmiri Muslims went to study at universities all over India. In 1931, among the first Kashmiri graduates to return to Srinagar, were Sheikh Mohammed Abdullah, Mirza Afzal Beg and G. M. Sadiq. These young men got politically involved and stood in opposition to the Maharaja's perceived autocracy.[14] What triggered this opposition, were a succession of incidents in Jammu wherein some state government officials had purportedly demolished a mosque. When this news reached Srinagar, it caused public outrage. On 25 June 1931, a Pakhtoon man called Abdul Qadeer made a seditious speech against the